pronouncements by Iranian officials had been conveying a more conciliatory tone toward the United States.

Not that there weren't problems: The Hizballah kidnappers were trying to become more independent of the Iranian Revolutionary Guards, and were demanding, as a price for releasing the remaining Americans, that the United States exert pressure on Kuwait to free seventeen Shiite terrorists imprisoned in that country after they had bombed the U.S. and French embassies there in 1983. There was no way we could do that. This was something nonnegotiable on our part: We wanted our hostages back, but we couldn't ask another country to go easy on convicted terrorists at the same time that we were asking the world to crack down on terrorism.

Despite this problem and various delays, disappointments, and frustrations, the Iranian initiative seemed to be working —and we were *not* trading arms for hostages. None of the arms we'd shipped to Iran had gone to the terrorists who had kidnapped our citizens.

After Father Jenco's release, Bill Casey and the NSC staff suggested we authorize a small additional shipment of spare missile parts to the Iranian military forces as a demonstration of goodwill and gratitude. If we didn't, Casey said, it was possible that our principal contact in the Iranian government might lose face and even be executed by those in Iran who were opposed to what he was doing. There was also the possibility, he said, that if we didn't give them a show of goodwill, one or more of the remaining three hostages might be killed. I authorized this additional shipment, and we went back to anxiously waiting for the other hostages to be set free.

About this same time, George Shultz came to me and said he wanted to resign; although he had never stopped letting me know that he didn't approve of the Iranian policy, that wasn't his reason: He thought that Cap Weinberger, Bill